

Entrepreneurship

In a world of accelerating change, where both challenges and opportunities abound, students need to learn how to live and work in an enterprising way, either as entrepreneurs who take the initiative to create new ventures or as enterprising individuals who apply their skills, attitudes, and abilities while working within the various organizations that contribute to our society. The need to be enterprising is further emphasized by the exponential growth of e-commerce and the economic opportunities it presents. Students will have opportunities to acquire the knowledge, skills, and attributes of entrepreneurs and enterprising employees by organizing an event, planning a school-based business, or completing a venture plan with an e-commerce component. Students will use these skills to learn how to live and work as creative problem solvers who welcome and successfully manage change.

Strands

Entrepreneurship: The Venture, Grade 11, College Preparation

- Enterprising People and Entrepreneurs
- Ideas and Opportunities for New Ventures
- The Benefits of a Venture Plan
- Developing and Completing a Venture Plan for the Proposed Business

Entrepreneurship: The Enterprising Person, Grade 11, Open

- The Changing Nature of the Workplace
- Entrepreneurship and the Enterprising Employee
- Enterprising Skills
- The Enterprising Experience: Planning and Organizing an Event

Entrepreneurship: Venture Planning in an Electronic Age, Grade 12, College Preparation

- E-Commerce and Venture Planning
- The Venture Concept
- Preparing for Start-up
- Targeting Customers
- Developing the Venture Plan

Entrepreneurship: Venture Planning in an Electronic Age, Grade 12, College Preparation

(BDV4C)

This course provides students with the opportunity to develop and apply entrepreneurial skills through the creation of a venture plan that capitalizes on the potential of e-commerce. Students will research and identify an opportunity for a venture. They will then complete the components of a venture plan that includes a website.

Prerequisite: None

E-Commerce and Venture Planning

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- analyse the challenges and opportunities of doing business on the Internet;
- evaluate the impact of e-commerce on small business;
- evaluate elements of website design for a small business.

Specific Expectations

E-Commerce Challenges and Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify types of e-commerce used by entrepreneurs (e.g., business to business, business to consumer, consumer to consumer);
- analyse the challenges of and trends in e-commerce of significance to entrepreneurs (e.g., keeping up with the increase in online commercial activity; trends in Internet sales to consumers and types of goods and services purchased online by businesses);
- identify opportunities in e-commerce for entrepreneurs (e.g., explore the Yellow Pages and identify businesses that are candidates for online commerce).

The Impact of E-Commerce

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain how e-commerce affects small business (e.g., increased competition, different methods of payment, increased worldwide market);
- identify the technical, security, and business risks involved with implementing e-commerce in a small business (e.g., viruses, hackers, credit card fraud);

- evaluate the ethical issues involved for small businesses that do business electronically (e.g., confidentiality, establishing credibility and integrity);
- evaluate the financial implications for a small business of doing business electronically (e.g., currency fluctuations, tariffs, shipping).

Evaluating Website Design

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify factors to consider when designing or commissioning a design for an e-business website for a small business (e.g., designer's personal expertise; available software; design elements, such as attractiveness, ease of use, speed of download);
- identify and describe the components of an effective website for a small business (e.g., home page, contact information, copyright, last updated date, links, search engine, menu);
- evaluate websites of current small businesses in terms of their design features (e.g., usability, ease of navigation, continuity of pages, appropriateness for audience, speed of download, contact information, methods of payment).

The Venture Concept

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- analyse the challenges and opportunities of the start-up phase of a business life cycle;
- identify and evaluate entrepreneurial opportunities in their community in order to select one well suited to their interests and capabilities;
- generate ideas that match their selected entrepreneurial opportunity and assess the idea that is most appropriate for a new venture;
- analyse the factors that would influence the form and type of their venture.

Specific Expectations

Start-up Challenges and Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- explain the stages in the life cycle of a business;
- summarize the factors that contribute to the success or failure of a new venture (e.g., technological skills and equipment; adequacy of capitalization; management and risk-management skills; ability to adapt to changes in economic conditions; environmental issues; effects of globalization; government policies);
- analyse the conditions (e.g., competitive, regulatory, economic, social, technological) facing ventures starting up in various markets.

Identifying and Evaluating Entrepreneurial Opportunities

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify community problems, needs, or wants, and explain how selected problems, needs, or wants could be addressed;
- analyse the opportunities for creating a new venture that are most suited to their particular entrepreneurial abilities and determine which opportunity is the most promising;

- identify community problems, needs, or wants that could best be addressed by a not-for-profit venture, and explain why.

Generating, Selecting, and Assessing Ideas

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify ways in which creative ideas can be generated (e.g., mind mapping, brainstorming) and describe the situations and conditions in which students tend to be most creative (e.g., when drawing or writing, in drama productions, when working as part of a team, when researching on the Internet);
- list possible ideas with regard to the identified new venture opportunity and select one idea that has the greatest potential for success;
- collect and compile feedback on what others think of the idea (e.g., present their idea to the class and summarize the feedback received) and, using the feedback, evaluate the idea in terms of its feasibility (e.g., its merit compared with alternatives, its match with their own interests and experience).

Types of Ventures

By the end of this course, students will:

- compare the various types of ventures (e.g., e-tail compared with retail, offering a service compared with producing a good, selling retail compared with selling wholesale);
- outline the importance of incorporating ethical practices and social responsibility in the operating of a venture;
- compare the various forms of business ownership (e.g., sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation, cooperative, franchise) and select the one most appropriate for their chosen opportunity and idea.

Preparing for Start-up

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- analyse the key components of a venture plan;
- organize the information and sources of information needed for the successful start-up of their venture;
- determine the human and physical resources needed for their venture;
- determine effective ways to manage their venture;
- determine the legal requirements of their venture;
- determine the financial requirements and sources of financing for their venture.

Specific Expectations

Venture Plan Components

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify and describe the components of a venture plan;
- compare a number of business plans in terms of their content, thoroughness, clarity, organization, social responsibility, and utility.

Organizing Information for Their Venture

By the end of this course, students will:

- establish a network of contacts that can help provide them with the information required for their venture (e.g., local entrepreneurs, local Chamber of Commerce, Rotary Club, Zonta Club);
- identify public and private secondary sources of useful information (e.g., the Yellow Pages, local business directories, government and industry statistical reports available on the Internet or in libraries);
- summarize the information gathered from primary and secondary sources.

Human and Physical Resources

By the end of this course, students will:

- determine the human resources (e.g., level and skill of employees) and related supports (e.g., benefit plans, training programs) their venture would require;

- specify the physical resources their venture would require (e.g., office or work space, equipment, machinery).

Management Requirements for Their Venture

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe the elements of a mission statement (e.g., business philosophy, vision, goals, objectives) and assess how they can affect the way a venture is managed;
- determine effective ways to manage their venture (e.g., complete an organizational chart, a production flow chart);
- describe how computer software (e.g., accounting software, contact management software) could be used to maintain accurate business records for their venture.

Legal Requirements

By the end of this course, students will:

- determine the legal requirements and estimated costs of establishing the form of business ownership for their venture (e.g., sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation) and registering the business name;
- identify municipal requirements regarding possible sites for their venture (e.g., local zoning regulations, licensing requirements, by-laws);

- describe how they would obtain patent, copyright, and/or trademark protection;
- compare the types and costs of insurance available for their venture;
- identify the international, federal, and provincial legislation relating to e-commerce and describe what these laws involve.
- identify and describe the financial statements required by their venture (e.g., income statement, balance sheet, cash-flow forecast);
- describe the moral and ethical issues that may arise when determining an acceptable level of profit for their venture;
- identify the advantages and disadvantages of various sources of capital for their venture (e.g., family, personal savings, bank loan, private equity, government grants);
- develop an effective strategy for raising capital for their venture.

Financing

By the end of this course, students will:

- estimate the amount of capital that would be required to launch their venture;
- differentiate between the resources required by their venture that are categorized as fixed costs and those that are variable costs;

Targeting Customers

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- analyse the size and composition of the potential market for their venture;
- develop effective promotional strategies for their venture.

Specific Expectations

Market Analysis

By the end of this course, students will:

- describe, on the basis of research (e.g., survey, personal observation), the potential customers for their venture;
- analyse strategies (e.g., pricing, promotion, distribution) for marketing the good or service that is the basis for their venture;
- analyse the impact of competition on their venture (e.g., on new opportunities, on future growth, on pricing policies).

Promotional Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

- develop an initial promotional strategy to launch their venture (e.g., a plan for the grand opening, coupons, giveaways);

- develop an advertising strategy (e.g., using flyers, brochures, banner advertisements, websites, local radio and television advertisements, word of mouth, publicity) and a promotional strategy (e.g., using business cards, coupons) to help establish and maintain an identity for their venture;
- analyse growth strategies (e.g., offering new products or services, developing new pricing policies, finding new channels of distribution) and expansion strategies (e.g., franchising, acquiring a competitor's business, establishing new branches) for their venture.

Developing a Venture Plan

Overall Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- produce, using appropriate computer software, the elements of a venture plan, including a production plan, marketing plan, human resources plan, management plan, and financial plan that are most appropriate for their proposed venture;
- design a website as part of their venture plan;
- assess and finalize the venture plan, including the website, and use it to assess the viability of their venture.

Specific Expectations

Preparing the Venture Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- develop, using appropriate software, the production, marketing, human resources, management, and financial components of their venture plan;
- use information technology for a variety of business purposes in the production of the venture plan;
- compare models of venture-planning frameworks (e.g., models available from Canadian financial institutions, the Entrepreneurship Centre);
- explain how different types of computer software can assist in venture planning (e.g., spreadsheet software to help prepare financial statements; chart wizard to help prepare graphs; website design software to facilitate the development of the website; word processing software to help prepare the text of the report and to create tables; desktop publishing software to help prepare advertisements);
- generate a draft version of their venture plan, using appropriate software.

Venture Website Design

By the end of this course, students will:

- define the purpose and target audience for their venture website;

- develop the website elements and content (e.g., text, images, navigation bars, logo, heading, e-commerce payment systems, copyright information);
- create an effective website for their venture (e.g., using OSAPAC software, MS Publisher, Dreamweaver).

Assessing and Revising the Plan, Including the Website

By the end of this course, students will:

- identify the individuals in their school and community who could assess and respond to their venture plan, including their website (e.g., peers, teachers, advisers, investors, bankers, relatives, community college/university faculty, business mentors);
- determine, on the basis of the feedback received, the revisions that should be made to their venture plan, including their website;
- produce a final version of their venture plan, including their website, demonstrating the effective use of business communication techniques;
- assess, on the basis of the information in the venture plan, the potential for the viability of the venture.